“Everyone I love eventually betrays me.”

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Where it often comes from

Repeated hurt by parents, partners, friends, or church can form a pattern: love ends in betrayal. We may expect it, pull away early, or test people until they fail. Sometimes we choose people who repeat the pattern, and the belief is then confirmed.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest about betrayal. The psalmist writes, “It is not an enemy who insults me… But it is you, a man like myself, my companion and close friend,” and “Even my close friend whom I trusted… has lifted up his heel against me.” Isaiah says of the Messiah, “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief.” Jesus was betrayed by Judas and denied by Peter. Yet after Peter’s failure, Jesus restored him. And God promises, “Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.” You are not alone in betrayal, and betrayal is not the final word.

> *“For it is not an enemy who insults me; that I could endure. It is not a foe who rises against me; from him I could hide. But it is you, a man like myself, my companion and close friend. We shared sweet fellowship together; we walked with the crowd into the house of God”* (Psalm 55:12–14).

Also see

> “Even my close friend whom I trusted, the one who shared my bread, has lifted up his heel against me” (Psalm 41:9).

> “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not” (Isaiah 53:3).

> “Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: ‘Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.’” (Hebrews 13:5).

> “When they had finished eating, Jesus asked Simon Peter, ‘Simon son of John, do you love Me more than these?’ ‘Yes, Lord,’ he answered, ‘You know I love You.’ Jesus replied, ‘Feed My lambs.’ Jesus asked a second time, ‘Simon son of John, do you love Me?’ ‘Yes, Lord,’ he answered, ‘You know I love You.’ Jesus told him, ‘Shepherd My sheep.’ Jesus asked a third time, ‘Simon son of John, do you love Me?’ Peter was deeply hurt that Jesus had asked him a third time, ‘Do you love Me?’ ‘Lord, You know all things,’ he replied. ‘You know I love You.’ Jesus said to him, ‘Feed My sheep.’” (John 21:15–17).

Common self-statements

- Everyone leaves in the end.
- Love always ends in betrayal.
- I should expect it.
- I will be hurt again.
- It is only a matter of time.
- I cannot count on anyone.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralizing: Treating repeated hurt as a universal rule.

- Fortune telling: Predicting betrayal.
- Mental filter: Remembering betrayals and forgetting loyal people.
- Self-fulfilling prophecy: Pulling away or testing people and causing the very break I fear.

Challenging questions

- Who has betrayed me, and what do these experiences have in common?
- Who has stayed loyal to me?
- What patterns in my choices or expectations might I need to examine?
- What does it mean that Jesus was betrayed too?
- How did Jesus respond to Peter after his failure?
- What would healthy trust look like?

Truth summary

> I have been betrayed, and the pain is real. But not everyone betrays, and I am not alone. Jesus knows betrayal and promises never to leave me. I can heal, examine my patterns, and learn to trust wisely.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Trust
- Friendship
- Hardship
- Forgiveness
- Loneliness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

The God Who Stays — Matthew West
God's faithful presence challenges the expectation of rejection and abandonment.

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

What a Friend We Have in Jesus — Keith and Kristyn Getty
This classic hymn invites direct, honest prayer with the Savior who carries our burdens.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Everyone I love eventually betrays me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Everyone I love eventually betrays me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has betrayed me?
- ☐ Who has stayed?
- ☐ What patterns do I notice?
- ☐ What did Jesus experience?
- ☐ How did He treat Peter?
- ☐ What does healthy trust look like?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus knows betrayal.
- ☐ God will never leave me or forsake me.
- ☐ Not everyone betrays.
- ☐ Betrayal is not the last word.
- ☐ Restoration is possible.
- ☐ I can choose and trust wisely.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 55:12–14**
  "For it is not an enemy who insults me; that I could endure. It is not a foe who rises against me; from him I could hide. But it is you, a man like myself, my companion and close friend. We shared sweet fellowship together; we walked with the crowd into the house of God."
- ☐ **Isaiah 53:3**
  "He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not."
- ☐ **Hebrews 13:5**
  "Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Loyal people: Each week, name one person who has been loyal and one way you showed appreciation.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 13:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God said, 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Trust" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List the loyal. Write names of people who have stayed with you.
- ☐ Look at patterns. With a counselor, examine the common threads in your relationships.
- ☐ Read John 21. See how Jesus restored Peter.
- ☐ Pray Hebrews 13:5. Thank God that He stays.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Everyone I love eventually betrays me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Loyal people noted
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Everyone I love eventually betrays me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, You know what betrayal feels like. Heal my wounds, help me see the faithful people around me, and teach me to love and trust wisely. Thank You that You never leave. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.